

I am at loss to understand the real motive of those who are opposing the payment of decent salaries to the Executive Directors and their alternates. If the Bank and the Fund are as important to the economic well-being of the world as we say they are, and if the Executive Directors are to play a significant role in the operation of these institutions, then a net salary of \$25,000 per year seems to us to be low - not high.

The payment of decent salaries to the Executive Directors and their alternates is especially important to those countries not entitled as a matter of right to appoint directors. The directors elected by the American Republics, for example, are elected for only two years. They must therefore accept the duties of office under the assumption that other persons may be elected to take their place at the end of two years. This means that they will be accepting a temporary position, the duties of which will require them and their families to live in another country. Under these circumstances, if the salaries paid are too low, it will mean that the primary qualification of a person to be elected director will be financial independence rather than ability.